



FREE RESOURCE · STEMFORGE

The STEM Partnership Starter Guide

A complete, honest evaluation guide for Kenyan school leaders — plus how STEMForge specifically answers the hard questions.

Thanks for requesting this guide. Part One is genuinely useful on its own, whether you end up partnering with STEMForge or evaluating someone else entirely. Part Two shows exactly how we answer the same questions we just told you to ask — so you can hold us to it.

Part One — How to Evaluate Any STEM Provider

Six things worth thinking through before you sign anything.

01

Start by defining the outcome, not the equipment

Before asking “what robotics kit should we buy,” ask “what should a student be able to do after one term that they couldn’t do before?” A clear, concrete outcome — such as “build and present a working prototype” — makes every other decision easier: curriculum, session length, and budget all follow from it.

A good outcome statement is specific enough that a parent, a student, and a BOM member would all describe it the same way if asked at the end of term.

02

Questions worth asking any STEM provider

Ask these before signing anything — and see Part Two for how STEMForge answers each one.

- Who actually teaches the sessions, and what is their background?
 - What does a student walk away with — a certificate, a portfolio, a working project?
 - What happens after the pilot term if we want to continue, pause, or stop?
 - Can we start with a single grade or class before committing school-wide?
 - How is progress actually measured — attendance, or demonstrated skill?
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03

A realistic budget range

In the Kenyan market, in-school STEM and robotics programs commonly run from a few thousand to a few tens of thousands of Kenyan shillings per student per term, depending on group size, equipment, and session frequency. Get more than one quote before deciding what is reasonable for your context — prices vary widely for good reasons (equipment ownership, instructor experience, class size).

Ask what is actually included in the quoted price — equipment, instructor time, curriculum materials, and any end-of-term showcase are sometimes billed separately even when a quote looks all-inclusive at first glance.

04

Pilot before you commit school-wide

The lowest-risk way to evaluate any provider is a single-class pilot for one term. It is enough time to judge real student engagement and results without betting the whole school's budget — or your own credibility — on an unproven fit.

A well-structured pilot has a defined end point and a defined decision: continue, expand, or stop. If a provider cannot describe what happens at the end of the pilot before it even starts, that is worth asking about directly.

05

What to watch for in the first session

Are students building or doing something themselves, or mostly watching a demonstration? Hands-on time is the single biggest predictor of whether a program will actually hold students' interest past the first novelty week.

Sit in on the first session if you can. Watch how many students are actively working versus watching — that ratio tells you more than any brochure will.

06

A simple checklist before you sign

- The outcome is written down, not just described verbally
 - You know exactly what happens after the pilot term
 - You have compared at least one other quote
 - You have seen (or will see) an actual session before committing school-wide
 - The instructor(s) and their background are named, not vague
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How STEMForge Answers These Questions

The same five questions from Section 2, answered directly. Use this to compare us against anyone else you talk to.

Who actually teaches the sessions, and what is their background?

During this founding-partner phase, sessions are led directly by our founding team rather than outsourced to rotating contractors — you are working with the people who built the program, not a hired instructor you have never met.

[STEMForge: replace with the real instructor name(s) and specific background before publishing]

What does a student walk away with?

Every program is structured around a tangible end-of-term outcome — a working project or prototype a student can demonstrate and explain, not just a certificate of attendance.

What happens after the pilot term?

You decide, with no obligation either way. A pilot carries no commitment to continue — if it is not delivering results, that is the end of it. If it is working, we discuss expanding the partnership at the same founding-partner pricing you started with.

Can we start with a single grade or class?

Yes — we recommend it. Starting with one class for one term is the standard way every STEMForge founding partnership begins, specifically so the risk sits with us proving it works, not with your school committing upfront.

How is progress actually measured?

By what a student can demonstrate at the end of term — not attendance records. [STEMForge: add your specific assessment method here once defined, e.g. a rubric, a showcase event, or a portfolio review]

Want to talk through any of this for your specific school?
No obligation — a discovery call is free either way.